had set much store by, Chandrasekaran underscored the need to strengthen human resources. He went a step further by recruiting talents without any geographical restrictions, through the ‘Reimagining TAS [Tata Administrative Services]’. The aim is to start a global internship programme to recruit 500 candidates from the best institutions, including the IIMs, Harvard and Stanford University. They are to be employed in the Tata companies, their social projects and the Trusts. In the process, talents are globally harnessed, opening the doors for the growth of a truly global perspective developing within the group, critically necessary for the success of the global group that Ratan had made. Its importance cannot be exaggerated as the lion’s share of the group’s revenue comes from overseas, and bringing talents from across the world would help identify disparate challenges and consumer preferences of different markets. As of 2022–23 164 students of twenty-two nationalities have joined the programmes and are working on twenty-five projects.

Chandrasekaran has also launched another important initiative named ‘Alingana’, a Sanskrit word meaning ‘to embrace’—another step to make the group future ready. It aims at protecting the environment to promote sustainability, a goal that Ratan had underscored, for instance, by harnessing the energy potential of hydrogen. Describing it in words that would give birth to a slogan, he says the aim is to ‘extend the Tata Group’s commitment from pioneer of industrial India, to pioneer of green India’. To get people to take part in this global goal, a ‘climate hub’ is under finalization where anyone would be free to participate.

Another significant initiative has been the creation of a future-ready scorecard, a variant of the kind used in relation to the JRD QV Award. Its objective is to assess the preparedness of every Tata company to meet future challenges in terms of financial fitness, management depth, governance standards and board strength, and have an action plan to go from amber to green. When the latter is achieved, ‘then we are future ready’, says Chandrasekaran. The scorecard will attach special significance to supply-chain resilience, human resources and the creation of management depth.

With the changes Chandrasekaran has ushered in the five years of his chairmanship, the group is no longer critically dependent on the benefaction from TCS. Today, steel, auto manufacturing and Tata consumer products are contributing majorly to the group’s revenues and profits. In addition, he attended to the debt issues of the group companies and dealt with the